

S01-03 - The Strixwolf Mother

Player read-aloud

A creature steps from behind the cart: wolf-bodied, owl-faced, wings folded tight. Two pups stumble behind her. Her eyes judge whether you are danger or mercy.

Scene summary

A strange winged wolf-owl mother guards her pups while feeding from the dead driver.

Visible choices

- Soothe her
- Attack her
- Back away
- Inspect from afar

Player questions

- Who notices the Strixwolf pups first, and why does that matter to you?
- What do you do with your hands so the mother knows you are not hunting?
- What sound tells you this is a parent, not a monster?

GM notes

- She is feeding on the driver but probably did not kill them. The slit throat clue points elsewhere.
- Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it.
- Use the generic Strixwolf profile only if the encounter escalates beyond the mother protecting her pups.
- Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.
- [REFLAVOR/GUARANTEED] The Strixwolf Mother is feeding pups and guarding them; she reacts to tone, not bloodlust. (Presence to calm; Instinct to read boundaries)
- [ADD/SEED] Helping the pups or sparing the mother earns Hope now and can create a later warning boon.

Checks and rolls

- Presence or Instinct Calm, redirect, or understand the mother. Standard Gain `strixwolf_trust` +1 if handled with mercy. 15 Cleanly resolve: Calm, redirect, or understand the mother. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to The Strixwolf Mother. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows

from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to reveal omitted risk, split attention, or put a human cost in front of the contract. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.

Clues

- Wound mismatch The creature scavenged. Humanoids killed Tamsin. The dead driver's wound is too clean for the strixwolf.
- Guaranteed seed The Strixwolf Mother is feeding pups and guarding them; she reacts to tone, not bloodlust. The Strixwolf Mother is feeding pups and guarding them; she reacts to tone, not bloodlust. Presence to calm; Instinct to read boundaries

Loot

- Shed feather warning token if helped
- No treasure; guilt if harmed
- Sablewood ecology clue: owl-wolf tracks show this predator belongs to a broader hybrid-fauna pattern, not a random monster table.

Mechanics

- Plot So Far: The party is in Act One pressure: A strange winged wolf-owl mother guards her pups while feeding from the dead driver.
- Mechanics In Play: Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting.
- Roll Cards: s01-03-approach-the-strixwolf-mother S01-03 Approach the Strixwolf Mother Approach the Strixwolf Mother Presence Instinct Presence Instinct 12 Presence lowers threat; Instinct reads animal boundaries. The mother protects her pups and may turn fear into violence. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The mother protects her pups and may turn...
- Gm Fear Spends: Make the safe road feel less safe: noise, scent, cracked wheel, or cargo hum. Separate evidence from assumption so a monster read is tempting but incomplete.
- Conditions Hazards: Vulnerable Restrained
- Search Loot Clues: Strixwolf aftermath: no treasure. Mercy can create a feather/down warning token; harm creates sadness and noise.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Escalation: Escalate by making cost visible: time, noise, trust, ward instability,

or someone vulnerable in danger.

- Deescalation: De-escalate through respect, care, honest testimony, useful evidence, or a concrete concession.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: The Strixwolf Mother asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Agility, Instinct, Presence. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
- Class Community Ancestry Reveals: Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress.
Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.

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